

In the reading this week, the theme of security and threats in Singapore is discussed. Rahim discusses Singapore's strategic culture and its reliance on a 'great and powerful' patron for security underscores the city-state's deep-seated insecurity and realist worldview.

The author highlights how Singapore's past and geographic vulnerability have shaped its national identity and security policies. However, I disagree with Rahim's portrayal of Singapore's relations with Malaysia and Indonesia as being solely driven by historical feuds and economic pressures. While I do agree that these factors are significant, however, there are also other factors that contributed to these relations, such as cultural and political narratives. For example, Rahim discusses Singapore's exclusion of Malay men from military service and the implications for regional relations could be further explored from the perspective of internal dynamics of Singapore's multiracial society and how it could influence its external relations. Understanding how Singapore's domestic cultural and political narratives intersect with its regional interactions could provide a more comprehensive view of its security policies and relations with neighboring countries. By examining these internal dynamics, we can better appreciate the multifaceted nature of Singapore's security challenges and the ways in which they are intertwined with both historical and contemporary factors.